



455 CE

THE VANDALS SACK ROME

In the 440s, the Roman Emperor Valentinian III strove to keep the peace with the Germanic Vandal barbarians, even betrothing his daughter Eudocia to the Vandal prince Huneric. Valentinian's successor Petronius Maximus broke this agreement. Outraged, Huneric's father, the Vandal King Genseric, landed with a fleet near Ostia and marched on Rome, stripping it of its remaining ancient treasures. Roman fleets sent in 460 CE and 468 CE to exact vengeance on the Vandals were easily destroyed, confirming Rome's terminal weakness.

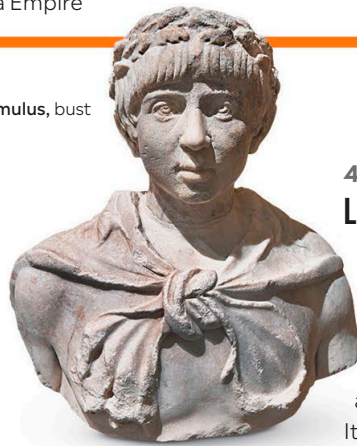
451 CE **Attila the Hun**

fails to defeat a Roman-Visigothic army at the Catalaunian Fields

467 CE **The death of Skandagupta** marks the start of the decline of the Indian Gupta Empire

455 CE **The Anglo-Saxon** invasion of England begins (traditional date)

▷ Romulus, bust



476 CE

LAST WESTERN EMPEROR

In 475 CE, the Roman official Orestes deposed Emperor Julius Nepos and elevated his own son Romulus to the throne. A revolt broke out among the Germanic mercenaries in the army, who demanded one-third of Italy's land. When Orestes refused, their general, Odoacer, seized the imperial capital Ravenna and deposed Romulus, the very last Western Roman emperor.

▽ The Monkey, Nazca line



c. 450 CE

NAZCA PEOPLE MAKE GEOGLYPHS IN THE DESERT

In the mid-5th century CE, the Nazca people of the southern Peruvian desert created some of the world's most spectacular geoglyphs (massive designs made by using coloured sand and gravel placed into shallow trenches). Some are hundreds of metres in length and depict animals such as monkeys, hummingbirds, and spiders; they can only be clearly seen from the air.

479 CE